

HiveForce Labs

# THREAT ADVISORY



## ATTACK REPORT

### The Menace of TrickGate: Packer-as-a-Service Spreading Malware Globally

Date of Publication

February 1, 2023

Admiralty Code

A1

TA Number

TA2023056

# Summary

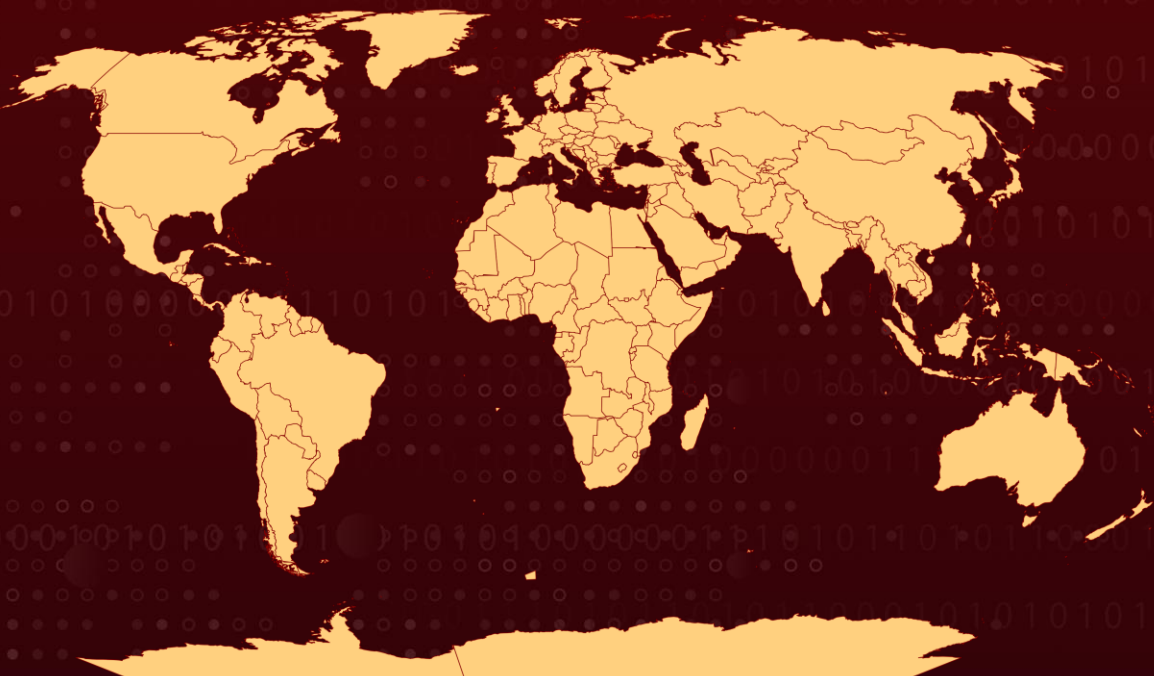
**First appeared:** July 2016

**Attack Region:** Worldwide

**Attack Sector:** Education facilities, Healthcare, Finance, and Business enterprises.

**Attack:** TrickGate is a notorious Packer-as-a-Service that has evaded detection from cyber security measures for over six years. Despite its elusive nature, it has managed to consistently improve its capabilities and is now being used to spread a wide range of malicious tools such as ransomware, remote access trojans (RATs), information stealers, bankers, and miners. The impact of TrickGate's attacks is felt globally, with Taiwan and Turkey being the countries most affected by its malicious activities.

## ✂ Attack Regions



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# Attack Details

## #1

TrickGate has bundled several of the most well-known top-distribution malware families, including Trickbot, Maze, Emotet, REvil, CoinMiner, Cobalt Strike, Formbook, Remcos, AgentTesla, and many others. Initial access is mainly achieved through phishing emails with malicious attachments or websites, with the initial files being primarily archived executable.

## #2

The shellcode loader is responsible for decrypting and executing the shellcode in the second step. It decrypts the payload and injects it into a new process covertly. The payload is the malicious code that performs the destructive action. The payloads vary based on the attacker's use of the packer.

# Recommendations



### Security Leaders

Phishing simulations and routine education and awareness training and communications rarely account for MFA fatigue and web browser hygiene. Integrate and communicate all lessons learned.



### Security Engineers

- **Uni5 Users:** This is an actionable threat advisory in HivePro Uni5. Prioritize and block all indicators attributed to the threat actors and attacks through your Command Center. Test your controls with Uni5's Breach & Attack Simulation.
- **All Engineers:** Refer to and action upon the 'Potential MITRE ATT&CK TTPs' & 'Indicators of Compromise (IoC)' on the following pages.

## Potential **MITRE ATT&CK** TTPs

|                                                    |                                                       |                                                      |                                              |
|----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| <b>TA0002</b><br>Execution                         | <b>TA0003</b><br>Persistence                          | <b>TA0004</b><br>Privilege Escalation                | <b>TA0005</b><br>Defense Evasion             |
| <b>TA0006</b><br>Credential Access                 | <b>TA0007</b><br>Discovery                            | <b>TA0009</b><br>Collection                          | <b>TA0011</b><br>Command and Control         |
| <b>TA0040</b><br>Impact                            | <b>T1047</b><br>Windows Management<br>Instrumentation | <b>T1059</b><br>Command and<br>Scripting Interpreter | <b>T1055</b><br>Process Injection            |
| <b>T1027</b><br>Obfuscated Files or<br>Information | <b>T1003</b><br>OS Credential Dumping                 | <b>T1057</b><br>Process Discovery                    | <b>T1486</b><br>Data Encrypted for<br>Impact |

## Indicator of Compromise (IOCs)

| TYPE       | VALUE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>MD5</b> | 03d9cbee9522c2c8a267b7e9599a9d245c35c7ac<br>043ae57e01ebd0a96fa30b92821b712504cfde03<br>1a455baf4ce680d74af964ea6f5253bbeeacb3de<br>22f26496f2e8829af9f5cfcd79c47e03fe9a21bb<br>24aa45280c7821e0c9e404f6ce846f1ce00b9823<br>30e0181a018fa7dcdbd2344dc32adcf77cf840ebe<br>3437ea9b7592a4a05077028d54ef8ad194b45d2f<br>3817bad277aa50016e08eed35e92d4a3b5247633<br>4380044a9517a08514459005836c5f92e4a33871<br>4f6fa448454b581d6c8e7aa6ed3ef72e66062bf8<br>666c5b23521c1491adeeee26716a1794b09080ec<br>75d999d431819311abf8bd048cd084acdcd5f4e1<br>7f456f8b01fc8866aeed4678a14479b6eaa62fed<br>975629358bfbba0344ef0dae4d22697ceb2a32b4<br>977800bd7be3c5c9f2c0dac7f4806e586d8f7b1a<br>9f20d00b4ec898a33e130720d4d29e94070e1575<br>a1f73365b88872de170e69ed2150c6df7adcdc9c<br>a661541c4cbeb1db859f6cec6c53979b5633c75e<br>afbe838c881e5b223351ff8fa05ddeb3678581ba<br>b2d58df71ce9c509fab1f00ce04c9526c60695<br>e6dccf4b1fc5ab116b6bc1321346b35dbf42f387<br>Fa5c79321dd4cc2fea795d6ebe2e823abe33ca6f |

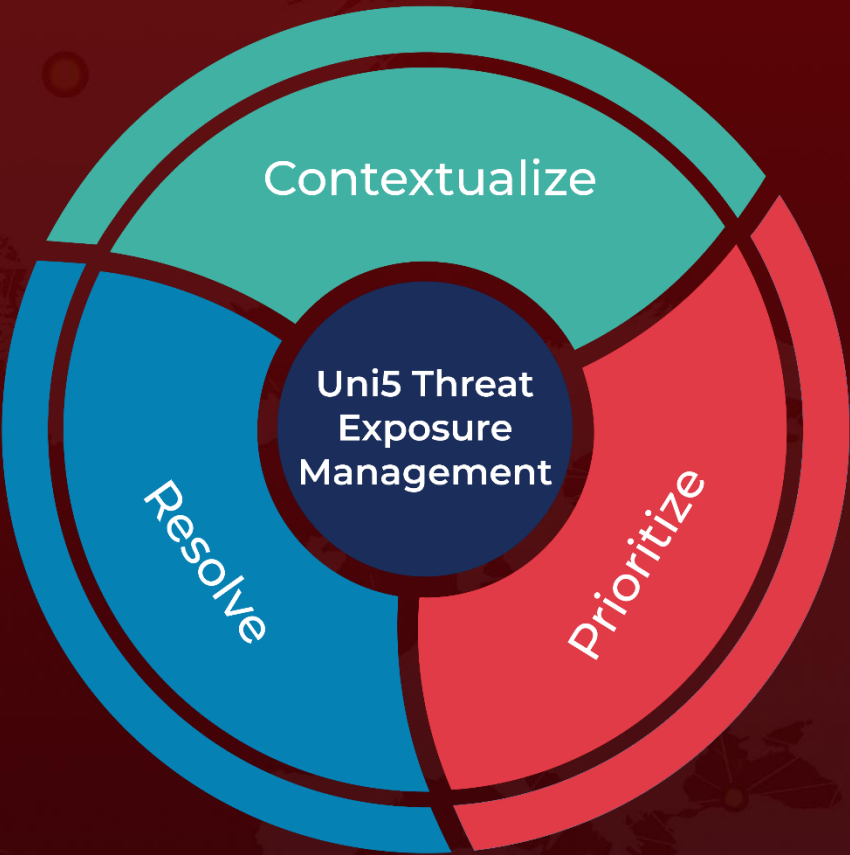
## References

<https://research.checkpoint.com/2023/following-the-scent-of-trickgate-6-year-old-packer-used-to-deploy-the-most-wanted-malware/#single-post>

# What Next?

At Hive Pro, it is our mission to detect the most likely threats to your organization and to help you prevent them from happening.

Book a free demo with HivePro Uni5: Threat Exposure Management Platform.



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